

Nine people, one broken homework contract

High school teachers who assign out-of-class work **struggle with students bypassing the cognitive effort required for learning**, because AI allows them to submit work without real comprehension — and they want to ensure students are actually learning.

- Good private preparatorias (not necessarily elite)
- Ages 15–18 · educación media superior
- Entry via Emiliano's network
- Every claim is a hypothesis until interviewed

Differentiated by **attitude toward AI** × **subject**: each teacher meets a different kind of assignment breakage — essays, problem sets, language production.

L

TEACHER · THE RESISTER

Profesora Lourdes

56 · Literatura e Historia · 28 years teaching

Built her career on the essay. Experiences AI as a **betrayal of the teacher–student pact** — and has retreated to paper, in class, under her eyes.

Resists AI

Embraces AI

GOALS

- Certainty that what she reads was thought by the student
- Keep essays and deep reading alive in her subject
- School backing with real, enforceable consequences

FRUSTRATIONS

- She can *feel* AI-written text but can prove nothing
- Handwritten workarounds cannibalize her teaching time
- No school policy — she's alone as "the strict one"

“Yo no le tengo miedo a la inteligencia artificial. Le tengo miedo a graduar generaciones que nunca tuvieron una idea propia.”

Vetoer

Low tech comfort

Paper + mandated LMS

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Resisters are a large share of teachers, not a shrinking fringe
- Retreat-to-paper is the dominant resister workaround — with a recognized pedagogical cost
- She'd accept a tool framed as "proving authorship", never one framed as "integrating AI"

A

TEACHER · THE PRAGMATIST

Profesor Andrés

41 · Matemáticas y Física · ~200 students, 2 schools

Photo-solvers broke math homework before ChatGPT did. Not angry — **rebalancing**: homework barely counts, exams carry everything. He knows this measures less.

Resists AI

Embraces AI

GOALS

- Know who can actually solve problems *before* the exam
- Keep homework useful without pretending its grades mean anything
- Net time savings within two weeks, or it's out

FRUSTRATIONS

- Homework is theater: assigned, AI-solved, pretend-graded
- The students who most need practice outsource it — and fail predictably
- "Show your work" is dead; nobody builds tools for math

“La tarea ya no me dice quién sabe. Me dice quién tiene mejor prompt. Yo me entero de quién sabe hasta el examen — y ahí ya es demasiado tarde.”

Pragmatic influencer

Moderate-high tech

Classroom · GeoGebra · ChatGPT

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- STEM pain is *early visibility of who is practicing*, not authorship-proof
- The homework-to-exams rebalancing is widespread in math/science
- ~2-week net time-saving is the real adoption bar for high-load teachers
- Dual-school, 200-student loads are common enough to kill unscalable features

R

TEACHER · THE EMBRACER

Miss Renata

29 · English (B1–C1) · 5 years, TESOL

Thinks the war is over and AI won — so the **assignment must change**, not the student. Redesigned everything around process and performance. It doesn't scale.

Resists AI

Embraces AI

GOALS

- Make process-based assessment sustainable at 150 students
- Prove her approach works — with evidence, not conviction
- A legitimate AI lane for students: critique your draft, never write it

FRUSTRATIONS

- Reviewing drafts, revisions and recordings is crushing her
- Colleagues dismiss her as naive; her rules contradict the ban next door
- The market only sells detectors — which she considers snake oil

“Prohibir la IA es como prohibir la calculadora en 1995. Mi problema no es que la usen — es que no tengo horas para evaluar el proceso en vez del producto.”

Champion

High tech comfort

No budget authority

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Embracers exist in meaningful numbers and self-identify quickly
- Her bottleneck is genuinely *scaling process assessment*, not policy
- A champion-teacher → director sales motion works (she can get a pilot approved)
- "AI as tutor, not ghostwriter" reassures parents rather than alarming them

Students

The problem actors — the product must work with or despite them

Differentiated by **AI usage pattern** × **motivation**: a spectrum from full bypass to full honesty — including the honest student the current system punishes.

S

STUDENT · THE HEAVY BYPASSER

Santiago

17 · 5° semestre · top-15% GPA (inflated)

Runs school like a portfolio: every assignment gets a cost-benefit call. **"I optimize, I don't cheat."** Keeps a prompt describing his own writing style.

Never lets AI write

AI does everything

GOALS

- Maximum GPA per hour — grades are currency for ITESM/UNAM
- Never get caught; maintain plausible deniability
- Nothing before university admission terminally matters

FRUSTRATIONS

- Synchronous formats (oral defenses, in-class writing) break his model
- Vague accusations without proof — he performs offense and wins
- Suppressed flicker: his GPA might be a bubble the exam will pop

No es trampa, es eficiencia. La escuela califica el documento, no lo que aprendí. Yo entrego el documento.

Adversary

ChatGPT Plus

Prompt library per teacher

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Bypassers are a minority whose prompt-sharing sets everyone's norms
- Even hardened bypassers comply when grading shifts to synchronous formats
- The "my GPA is a bubble" anxiety is real and reachable — a wedge for making learning visible

V

STUDENT · THE SELECTIVE USER

Valeria

16 · 3° semestre · B+ · scholarship at stake

8 subjects, volleyball, family business on weekends. AI is the release valve — but she triages. Her line isn't difficulty, it's **perceived pointlessness**.

Never lets AI write

AI does everything

GOALS

- Grades good enough to keep her scholarship — real financial stakes
- Protect time for chemistry, volleyball, family
- Not fall behind in the subjects she automates (she worries)

FRUSTRATIONS

- Copy-from-the-book busywork that insults her time
- Zero load coordination across 8 subjects' teachers
- Santiago-types outscore her while she rations her honesty

Si la tarea es copiar del libro al cuaderno, la hace la IA y no me quita el sueño. Mi esfuerzo lo guardo para lo que sí me enseña algo.

Swing voter — the majority

Free ChatGPT

Also uses AI as tutor

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Selective users are the largest segment; the triage line is *perceived assignment value*
- Assignment redesign moves her more than enforcement does
- She'd trade transparency about legitimate AI use for protection from false accusations
- Load-coordination failure is a root cause teachers and directors underestimate

R

STUDENT · THE HONEST LOW-USER

Rodrigo

16 · 4° semestre · A– earned the hard way

Does the work, loves learning, wants to study law. Now punished from both directions: **outcompeted by cheaters, suspected for being good**.

Never lets AI write

AI does everything

GOALS

- Have his effort count — differentiation from those who outsource
- A way to prove his work is his, on his terms
- Keep his motivation alive in a system that calls him a sucker

FRUSTRATIONS

- His honest B+ sits next to AI-polished A's — indistinguishable on paper
- Accused of AI use *for writing well*, twice
- No channel to signal honesty — and his resolve is eroding

Hice todo bien y me preguntaron si lo escribí yo. Los que lo hicieron con ChatGPT sacaron diez. Dime tú para qué me esfuerzo.

Beneficiary & moral test

Keeps drafts as self-defense

Avoids even legitimate AI

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Honest students would *opt in* to process visibility rather than resent it
- False accusations of strong students are a top-3 parent-escalation trigger
- Directors recognize and fear the demoralization of honest students
- The erosion path is real: honest students convert over time — this is urgent, not chronic

Directors

The buyers — they sign the check

All Directors General, differentiated by **attitude toward AI policy**: prohibition, embrace-as-marketing, and the skeptic every edtech vendor has already burned.

B

DIRECTOR · THE PROHIBITIONIST

Directora Beatriz

58 · Traditional values school · ~700 students

Her school sells formation: values, discipline, character. AI homework is **dishonesty, full stop**. She banned it — and knows the ban is a dead letter.

Ban AI

Market AI

GOALS

- A rule with teeth — enforceable, uniform, defensible
- Zero scandals; keep AI conflicts out of parent WhatsApp groups
- Sanctions that survive an angry parent with a lawyer

FRUSTRATIONS

- Her unenforceable ban quietly undermines her authority
- Detector false positives already produced one ugly parent meeting
- Vendors pitch "AI literacy" — reading the room exactly backwards

“En este colegio la honestidad no es negociable. Lo que necesito no es otro discurso sobre el futuro — necesito poder demostrar quién hizo la tarea.”

Economic buyer, values-gated

Pays for enforceability

Rejects "AI integration"

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Prohibitionists are a substantial segment of good private schools
- They'll pay for evidence/enforceability even while rejecting AI-embracing framings
- "Defensible evidence" beats "detection accuracy" as the message
- A dead-letter ban is the common end-state of prohibition — it creates demand

F

DIRECTOR · THE INNOVATOR

Director Fernando

45 · Growth-focused school · ~1,100 students

Decided early that AI is an **enrollment story** — "we teach AI responsibly" wins the open house. Behind the talk, there is no operational substance yet.

Ban AI

Market AI

GOALS

- A parent-legible program with artifacts he can show at open house
- Teacher adoption real enough that the story holds when parents ask students
- Be first: the case study, the press mention, the lighthouse status

FRUSTRATIONS

- The brochure-reality gap a skeptical parent could expose
- Half his faculty quietly bans AI, contradicting the school's public position
- No data on actual use, learning, or integrity — all narrative, no evidence

“Los papás ya no preguntan si tenemos laboratorio de cómputo. Preguntan qué hacemos con la inteligencia artificial. El colegio que tenga la mejor respuesta se lleva las inscripciones.”

Eager economic buyer

Fastest sales cycle

Shelf-ware churn risk

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- "Responsible AI" genuinely moves enrollment decisions — or is it noise vs. price/placement?
- Innovators pay a premium for parent-facing evidence layered on teacher tools
- The brochure-reality gap creates one-budget-cycle urgency
- Lighthouse/founding-school positioning accelerates the close

P

DIRECTOR · THE EDTECH-BURNED SKEPTIC

Directora Patricia

50 · Well-regarded mid-size school · ~900 students

Bought the adaptive platform, the anti-plagiarism suite, the tablets. All dead. Operating principle: **no tool solves a practice problem** — prove month-six adoption.

Ban AI

Market AI

GOALS

- Learning integrity her faculty will genuinely sustain — not a purchased alibi
- Protect teacher time and trust; never impose top-down again
- Pilot first, pay for outcomes, easy exit

FRUSTRATIONS

- Every deck says "AI-powered"; nobody shows month-six retention data
- Caught between her resisters demanding bans and embracers demanding tools
- A detector false positive nearly cost her a family and a teacher in one week

“Cada plataforma que he comprado me la vendieron como la solución definitiva. La única tecnología que sobrevive en mi colegio es la que los maestros piden por su nombre.”

Hardest, most valuable buyer

Pilot-gated

Teacher-veto empowered

ASSUMPTIONS TO VALIDATE

- Burned skeptics are the modal director — making adoption evidence the core sales asset
- Bottom-up teacher demand genuinely unlocks her budget
- Pilot-priced, easy-exit offers materially shorten her cycle
- Resister tolerance (her Lourdes accepting the tool) is a purchase requirement

How the nine interlock

STRATEGIC HYPOTHESIS

Detection is a dead end. The only frame where all nine incentives align is *making learning visible* — process evidence and assessment formats where honest effort is provable, worthwhile, scalable to grade, enforceable, marketable, and demonstrably adopted.

Provable for **Rodrigo** · worthwhile for **Valeria** · scalable for **Renata** and **Andrés** · enforceable for **Lourdes** and **Beatriz** · marketable for **Fernando** · adoption-proven for **Patricia**. Nobody's incentives align on better catching.

THE CLASSROOM TRIANGLE

- Lourdes** is in an arms race with **Santiago** — and her collateral damage is **Rodrigo**. Her retreat to paper punishes **Valeria**'s legitimate constraints too.
- Andrés** has already conceded homework; his pain is not knowing who's practicing until the exam exposes them.
- Renata** has the pedagogy that would convert Valeria, protect Rodrigo, and constrain Santiago — but it doesn't scale without tooling.

THE BUYING TRIANGLE

- Beatriz** writes the policy **Lourdes** wants and can't enforce it; **Santiago** is her scandal risk, **Rodrigo**'s parents her legal risk.
- Fernando** showcases **Renata** but hasn't equipped her; his gap is exposed the day a parent asks **Valeria** how school "teaches AI responsibly."
- Patricia** will only buy what Renata demands *and* Lourdes tolerates — she is the adoption test the whole market imposes.

SHARPEST TENSION TO RESOLVE

Beatriz will not buy anything that "embraces AI." **Fernando** will not buy anything that smells like prohibition.

Can one product serve both with different framing — or is this two segments, forcing a beachhead choice?

KILL CRITERIA — EVIDENCE THAT CHANGES DIRECTION

- Teachers rank grading workload above integrity → this is a grading tool with integrity as a feature
- Even Rodrigos reject process visibility as surveillance → the "prove your work" wedge dies
- No school-level willingness to pay → revisit segment or business model
- The Beatriz/Fernando framing conflict is unbridgeable → pick one beachhead before building

DISCOVERY INTERVIEW PLAN — ROUND 1 · ~20 CONVERSATIONS · 3–4 WEEKS · VIA EMILIANO'S NETWORK

SEGMENT	TARGET	SCREENING FOR	INTERVIEW SEED
Teachers	6–8	Assigns take-home work; 3+ years experience; 2+ per attitude, covering humanities, STEM, English	Each teacher card's assumptions
Students	5–6	Uses or deliberately avoids AI on homework; mix of semesters	Valeria's triage line; Rodrigo's opt-in appetite
Directors	3–4	Decision authority over edtech; at least one values-traditional, one growth-oriented	Willingness-to-pay framing: evidence vs. innovation

Interview discipline: ask about past behavior ("tell me about the last time you suspected an AI-written assignment — what did you do?"), never hypothetical futures. Update or kill these personas after every 5 interviews.

Proto-personas, v2 · Built by the team (Emiliano, Matheus, Alejo, Joanna, Moritz, Marielle) · Every claim on this board is a hypothesis until customer discovery confirms or kills it.